

A PROPOSAL FOR THE GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM

Assam's Workforce, Everywhere.

অসম আমাৰ ঘৰ। অসমীয়াৰ বাবে কাম আমাৰ লক্ষ্য।

Protect, upskill and uplift Assam's workers — wherever they are, and skill its youth for the jobs coming home.

Every month, young Assamese leave home to build the rest of India — often in unsafe, low-paid, invisible work. This is how Assam **finds them, protects them, and lifts them up** — and builds the pathway home.

Prepared for Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma · Government of Assam

BetterPlace · verifyBetter · skillBetter · gigBetter · staffBetter · betterMoney

Every month, Assam's young leave home to build the rest of India.

Assam's people want to work — its labour-force participation is among India's highest. But the jobs aren't at home. So hundreds of thousands migrate for construction, plywood, hotels, security and factory floors across the country.

Around 50 young men die every month after leaving their homes in search of work. This is a painful reality.

— Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, Chief Minister of Assam, Feb 2026

66.9%

labour-force participation — among India's highest. People want work.

ACTUAL

PLFS 2023-24

4.26 L

workers returned to Assam during COVID — and even that is an undercount

FLOOR

ASSAM TRIBUNE

~8 L

Assamese estimated in Kerala alone — in construction & allied work

ESTIMATE

ASSAM TRIBUNE

21.16 L

registered educated job-seekers in Assam — qualified, but no local jobs

ACTUAL

ASSAM ECON. SURVEY, 2024

One state's youth, holding up others' economies.

Assamese workers are the backbone of construction, plywood, seafood and hospitality across India — usually as the lowest-paid, least-protected hands on site.

Kerala

~8 lakh Assamese (est.). Perumbavoor's plywood hub — 1.5 lakh+ migrants — runs on Assamese labour.

Tamil Nadu

Seafood & fish processing, SEZ and power-plant construction around Chennai & Ennore.

Karnataka & Delhi–NCR

Construction and hospitality. Assam is among Karnataka's top migrant-source states.

56.5%

of migrant construction workers are helpers — the bottom rung ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

23.5%

work as masons — a step up, still informal ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

~20%

hold a skilled role — most never get there ACTUAL

KERALA SURVEY

6

core sectors: construction, plywood, seafood, hotels, security, factories

Assam cannot protect a workforce it cannot see.

There is no database of Assam's outbound workers. They leave without informing anyone. The state learns of them **only after abuse, accidents — or death.**

- **Ennore, Oct 2025** — 9 Assamese workers died in an accident at an SEZ power-station site.
- **Tamil Nadu, 2026** — 2 Assamese women among 9 killed in an ammonia-gas leak at a seafood unit.
- **Arunachal, 2026** — 7 Mising youths rescued from starvation and abuse at a construction site.

Today the state brings home the bodies. The care comes after death. It should come before.

0

databases of Assam's outbound workers — the state can't see who is where **REPORTED**

ASSAM TRIBUNE

#1

Assam tops the Northeast for human trafficking — a known source state **NCRB**

NCRB / EASTMOJO

354

deceased migrant workers' bodies returned under the Shraddhanjali scheme by 2026 **ACTUAL**

GOVT. OF ASSAM

e-Shram

registers workers but never tags "migrant" — so no one can be found or protected

E-SHRAM

Unskilled, unverified, unprotected.

Most Assamese migrants enter as helpers and stay there — at the bottom of the wage ladder, with no papers and no safety net.

- **Stuck at the bottom.** 81% of India's construction workforce is unskilled — the exact bracket Assamese enter as helpers.
- **Low wages, locked in.** Assam tea wages are ₹280/day — among India's lowest — pushing youth out into more of the same.
- **Welfare doesn't travel.** Benefits are state-registered; nothing follows a worker across the border.

A certificate is the difference between a helper and a skilled worker — and between invisible and insurable.

81%

of India's construction workers are unskilled — the helper trap ACTUAL

KNIGHT FRANK, 2023

₹280

a day — Assam tea-garden wage, among the lowest in India ACTUAL

2025

₹525 → 605

the wage ladder: unskilled → skilled. Certification is the classifier ACTUAL

STATUTORY WAGES, 2025

12 L+

work Assam's tea gardens — a young generation wants beyond plucking leaves ACTUAL

2025

And now — the jobs are finally coming to Assam.

Advantage Assam 2.0 loaded the **largest investment pipeline in the state's history** — and its jobs are overwhelmingly frontline: semiconductor assembly, plant construction, energy, logistics, hospitality.

For the first time, a young Assamese can build a career **without boarding a train to Kochi**. The state that skills its youth before the plants open keeps those jobs — and can call its people home.

Every MoU becomes a local job only if a verified, skilled Assamese worker is ready — in the right district, in the right month.

₹4.91 L Cr

committed at Advantage Assam 2.0 (Feb 2025) — the state's largest-ever pipeline **ACTUAL**

GOVT. OF ASSAM, 2025

₹27,000 Cr

Tata Electronics semiconductor plant at Jagiroad — anchor of the wave **ACTUAL**

TATA ELECTRONICS, 2025

~27 K

direct + indirect jobs projected from the Jagiroad plant alone **PROJECTION**

MEDIA-REPORTED

6

frontline engines: chips, energy, logistics, tourism, agro & q-commerce **ACTUAL**

ADVANTAGE ASSAM 2.0

Build the jobs at home. But protect our people already out there.

Our aim is to ensure that the children of Assam do not have to leave their families and go outside the State for work.

— Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, Chief Minister of Assam

Atmanirbhar Asom is the right long game. But hundreds of thousands are **already outside today** — and every month, families lose a son. We don't wait for that day. We reach Assam's workers wherever they are.

1 Protect now

Verify every worker, carry welfare & insurance across state lines, and give them an SOS line that works anywhere in India.

2 Upgrade now

Upskill helpers into certified, better-paid, insurable jobs — in their own language, on their own phone.

3 Bring home later

Feed skilled, experienced Assamese back into Jagiroad, the refineries and the logistics parks the ₹4.91L Cr pipeline is building.

One Assamese worker. One verified profile. Everywhere they go.

An **Assam Worker Stack** — a verified, portable, lifelong profile that follows every Assamese worker across India, carrying their identity, welfare and skills. The state's living record of its people, wherever they work.

- 01 **Assam owns the data.** We run the engine. The registry and control stay with the state.
- 02 **It travels with the worker.** Identity, welfare and skills move across every border — one profile, for life.
- 03 **Proactive, not after-death.** The state sees and protects a worker before harm, not once a body comes home.

Formalise the migrant workforce the way UPI formalised payments — trusted, verified, built for scale.

SERVES

CM Dashboard

REAL-TIME

The Worker

ONE PROFILE

Employers

VERIFIED

Welfare Boards

PORTABLE



**Assam Worker ·
Verified**

Portable · lifelong

✓ VERIFIED

✓ Identity & skills — **certified**

✓ Welfare & insurance — **linked, portable**

PORTABLE RECORD

ASSAM WORKER STACK

FED AUTOMATICALLY BY

e-Shram

EPFO

ESIC

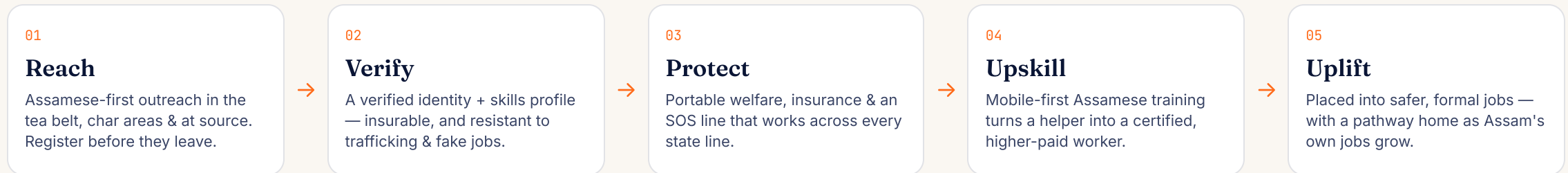
ASDM

Labour Dept

Orunodoi

Reach. Verify. Protect. Upskill. Uplift.

We don't hand the state a portal. We run the full loop — and hand back workers who are seen, protected and moving up.



↳ EVERY WORKER SEEN, PROTECTED AND UPGRADED — AND COUNTED ON THE CM'S DASHBOARD ↳

Protection that travels with the worker.

Turn the state's care from a repatriation scheme into a shield that follows every Assamese worker, alive and well, wherever they go.

◆ Portable welfare & insurance

Social security that crosses state borders — accident & life cover from day one, benefits that don't reset when a worker moves.

◆ Financial inclusion

Bank-linked wages, savings, easy remittance home and early-wage access — so families are protected, not indebted (betterMoney).

◆ Safe migration & anti-trafficking

Verified employers, a registered trail and an SOS grievance line — so a missing worker can be found, and a fake job flagged.

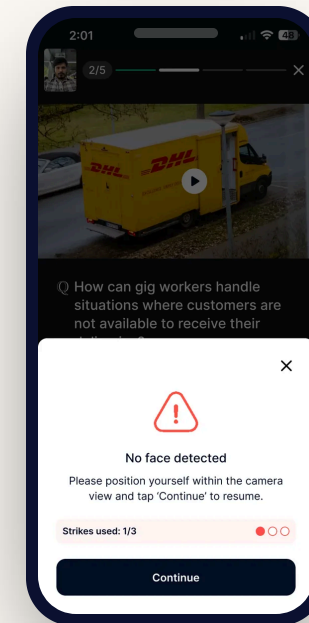
◆ From Shraddhanjali to prevention

The state already brings the fallen home. We help keep them safe while they live — the same intent, made proactive.

From helper to skilled — in their own language.

Mobile-first, Assamese-first training that turns an unskilled helper into a **certified, higher-paid, insurable** worker — and opens the door to formal jobs.

- **The ladder:** helper ₹525 → skilled ₹605+ a day. Certification is what moves them up.
- **The tracks:** masonry, electrical, welding, plumbing, security (PSARA), hospitality, driving & delivery.
- **Global-ready:** language & skills for the CM's Flight Scheme — Assamese youth placed abroad.



CERTIFY ON A LOW-COST PHONE • LIVE IN THE SKILLBETTER APP

The plants are coming. Skill for them the right way.

India's experience is consistent — state skilling built **without live employer demand** produces certificates, not jobs. Karnataka's own audit found just **18% of trainees placed against a 70% target**, courses chosen without vacancy evidence.

Assam can leapfrog that mistake: wire skilling to the **named, dated demand** of Jagiroad, the refineries and the logistics parks — before they switch on.

BetterPlace's model is the inversion: demand first, placement verified, paid on outcomes.

Role-level demand mapping

Cleanroom & assembly operators, industrial electricians, welders, warehouse associates, hospitality staff — the exact roles the pipeline hires, mapped district by district.

Women-first pipelines

Electronics assembly is a proven women's-employment engine across Asia. Assam can design women-first tracks into Jagiroad from day one.

Timing is everything

Skilling has a lead time. Plants hiring in 12–24 months need sourcing & training **started now**.

We're already where Assam works.

Kochi, Chennai, Bengaluru, Delhi — the exact cities Assamese migrate to. We don't have to find them from Guwahati. We're already there.

500+

cities live across India & SE Asia — the destinations, not just the source

30M+

frontline workers on the platform

COMPANY

2.5M+

workers skilled to date

COMPANY

Asom-first

AI in Assamese, on a low-cost phone

◆ The reach to find them

An on-ground network in the very cities Assamese work — so a worker in Perumbavoor or Ennore is one we can already reach, verify and protect.

◆ The data to place them

The largest verified frontline workforce dataset in Asia — matching skilled Assamese to safer, better-paid, formal employers.

Your priorities, made real on the ground.

You have set the direction. What's missing is the engine that reaches, protects and upgrades workers where they actually are.

Advantage Assam 2.0 · Jagiroad

The ₹4.91L Cr pipeline needs a ready Assamese workforce — we skill and place them into it, and feed experienced migrants home.

Shraddhanjali, made proactive

You bring the fallen home. We help protect them before harm — verified, insured, reachable.

CM Flight Scheme · global jobs

Verified, certified, language-ready Assamese candidates for international placement, including Japan.

The placement gap you named

The department admits it has no scheme to place Assam's 15.4 lakh registered unemployed. This is that scheme — built on ASDM & the Skill University.

No Assamese should be invisible, unskilled or unprotected — not in Guwahati, and not in Kochi.

— THE ON-RAMP

Start with one corridor. Prove it in 90 days.

A migration-corridor pilot that proves protection, upskilling and the live dashboard before any statewide rollout.

— THE 90-DAY PILOT

One corridor + one source district — the Assam→Kerala construction & plywood belt (Perumbavoor), plus a tea-belt district at home.

Register, verify, welfare-enroll & upskill a first cohort — with insurance and an SOS line live from day one.

First cut of the CM dashboard — a live map of who is where, and who is protected.

PHASE 1 • 0-6 MO

Corridor Pilot

One corridor + one district live · dashboard stood up.

PHASE 2 • 6-18 MO

Top Corridors

Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka corridors · Assam Worker ID statewide.

PHASE 3 • 18-36 MO

Every Worker Seen

Full stack · real-time CM dashboard · pathway-home placements.

— WHAT WE ASK

Policy sponsorship

Endorsement under ASDM & the Labour & Welfare department.

Data & platform access

Linkage to e-Shram, welfare boards & the Shraddhanjali registry.

A joint working group

With Labour, Skill Development & Special Branch, convened within **30 days**.

A live map of every Assamese worker in India.

Seen

every outbound worker registered & verified — the data gap, closed

Protected

portable welfare, insurance & an SOS line that crosses borders

Upgraded

helpers certified into safer, higher-paid, formal jobs

1

real-time dashboard — who is where, who is safe, who is placed

Targets, not promises — scaled from the corridor pilot. Every worker verified and counted on the CM's dashboard.

Assam becomes the first state that can see, protect and uplift its workers — wherever in India they are. Fewer bodies come home. More skilled workers do.

Assam already brings its workers home. Let's protect them while they're away.

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We're asking for your endorsement, and for **BetterPlace as Assam's delivery partner** — starting with a 90-day corridor pilot, so no Assamese worker is invisible, unskilled or unprotected.

What we'd like to walk out with

01 Endorsement of the vision & BetterPlace as execution partner

02 A committed 90-day corridor pilot

03 A joint working group convened within 30 days

The evidence behind this proposal.

- 1 **CM Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma** — "≈50 young men die every month after leaving home for work"; "children of Assam should not have to leave for work." Assam Tribune, Feb 2026. Re-elected for a 2nd term (2026 Assam election).
- 2 **Out-migration scale** — ~72 lakh unorganised workers on e-Shram (a floor; not migrant-tagged); 4.26 lakh returned during COVID; ~8 lakh Assamese estimated in Kerala. Assam Tribune; Sentinel Assam.
- 3 **Kerala construction split** — 56.5% helpers, 23.5% masons, ~20% skilled (survey). Perumbavoor plywood hub (1.5 lakh+ migrants) runs on Assamese labour. IJSSHR; Deccan Herald.
- 4 **Assam labour market** — LFPR 66.9% (PLFS 2023–24); 21.16 lakh registered educated job-seekers (2024); 15.4 lakh registered unemployed (Jun 2026); dept. admits no in-state placement scheme. Assam Econ. Survey; Sentinel Assam.
- 5 **The trap** — 81% of India's construction workforce unskilled (Knight Frank, 2023); Assam tea wage ₹280/day; wage ladder ₹525→₹605 with certification.
- 6 **Human cost** — Ennore (9 deaths, Oct 2025); ammonia-leak deaths (2026); Mising youths rescued from abuse (2026). Assam = NE's top trafficking source state (NCRB). Assam Tribune; EastMojo.
- 7 **Government response** — Shraddhanjali scheme (Oct 2025): 354 bodies repatriated by 2026 — reactive, after death. Govt. of Assam.
- 8 **The investment wave** — Advantage Assam 2.0 (Feb 2025): ₹4.91 lakh Cr of commitments; Tata Electronics ₹27,000 Cr semiconductor OSAT at Jagiroad (~27,000 direct+indirect jobs projected, media-reported). Govt. of Assam; Tata Electronics.
- 9 **The skilling lesson** — Karnataka CAG Report No. 6 of 2025 (CMKKY): 18% placement vs 70% target — the national case for demand-first skilling.
- 10 **Schemes to build on** — ASDM, Assam Skill University (Mangaldai), Orunodoi, CM's Atmanirbhar Asom self-employment scheme, CM Flight Scheme (global placement).
- 11 **BetterPlace company figures** — present in 500+ cities; 30M+ workers, 2.5M+ skilled. Company-reported.

Migration "scale" figures are estimates or administrative floors — Assam keeps no census of its outbound workers. Incident tolls are from single-outlet reports; verify each before publication. Company figures are company-reported. Year-3 outcomes are targets.